

## ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

### PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in the letters to the editor section of a newspaper in Hong Kong:

#### End to printed handouts good green initiative

Earlier this year, the University of Hong Kong banned the sale of disposable bottled water on its Pok Fu Lam campus. This green initiative was welcomed.

Now, in this new academic year, one department at HKU has implemented an unprecedented policy – a ban on giving printed paper handouts to students. .

I believe this is the right thing to do, and the initiative should be adopted by other departments and the other universities in Hong Kong as well.

A semester at our universities lasts about three months, so students will use any handouts that they are given for a very short period of time only. After the term ends, they will probably not be read again.

Sometimes, lecturers even print out in-class activity materials that are only used for a few minutes. This is such a tremendous waste of paper.

Nearly all university students these days own laptops. These can be used to access online learning resources systems (in HKU and most of the other universities, it is called Moodle) onto which lecturers will upload teaching materials. As long as teachers upload their handouts, there is no need for printouts.

This can significantly reduce the amount of paper used for teaching purposes. It is through this kind of cooperation that we can ensure the sustainability of our world.

*Anson C.Y. Chan, North Point*

Your school is planning on introducing 'paperless classrooms'. The school principal has asked students for their opinion on the idea. You may want to talk about:

- how schools can become paperless
- what challenges there will be
- whether you think it will be successful
- anything else you think is important

### PART B Individual Response

1. Do you use a lot of paper at school?
2. How often do your teachers give you handouts?
3. Do you prefer working on paper or on a laptop?
4. Do your teachers let you do homework online?
5. Do you keep your school handouts and books after your exams?
6. Does modern technology, such as laptops, improve teaching and education?
7. Are some subjects better done with paper rather than online?
8. Does using IT help to improve the environment?